

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

POLICY COMMITTEE
RECOMMENDATION

FOR ENGROSSED

SENATE BILL NO. 2045

By: Stanley of the Senate

and

Lowe of the House

POLICY COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATION

An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.9, which relates to physical education program requirements; requiring certain schools to provide students in certain grades certain amount of daily recess as a condition of accreditation; allowing daily recess to be broken into segments; defining term; requiring daily recess to occur outdoors when permitted; prohibiting depriving students of recess as a punishment; removing language encouraging certain amount of recess in certain grades; requiring certain subject matter standards to address certain plan; updating statutory language; providing an effective date; and declaring an emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.9, is amended to read as follows:

Section 11-103.9. A. Except as otherwise provided for in this section, the State Board of Education shall require, as a condition

1 of accreditation, that school districts provide to all students
2 physical education programs which may include athletics.

3 B. The Board shall require, as a condition of accreditation,
4 that public elementary schools provide instruction, for students in
5 full-day kindergarten and grades one through five, in physical
6 education or exercise programs for a minimum of an average of sixty
7 (60) minutes each week. The time students participate in recess
8 shall not be counted toward the sixty-minutes-per-week physical
9 education requirement. Schools may exclude from participation in
10 the physical education or exercise programs required in this
11 subsection those students who have been placed into an ~~in-house~~ in-
12 school suspension or detention class or placement or those students
13 who are under an in-school restriction or are subject to an
14 administrative disciplinary action.

15 C. The Board shall require, as a condition of accreditation,
16 that public elementary schools provide to students in full-day
17 kindergarten and grades one through five, in addition to the
18 requirements set forth in subsection B of this section, an average
19 of sixty (60) minutes each week of physical activity, which may
20 include, but not be limited to, physical education, exercise
21 programs, fitness breaks, ~~recess,~~ and classroom activities, and
22 wellness and nutrition education. Each school district board of
23 education shall determine the specific activities and means of
24 compliance with the provisions of this subsection, giving

1 consideration to the recommendations of each school's Healthy and
2 Fit School Advisory Committee as submitted to the school principal
3 pursuant to the provisions of Section 24-100a of this title.

4 D. The Board shall require, as a condition of accreditation,
5 that public elementary schools provide to students in full-day pre-
6 kindergarten, full-day kindergarten, and grades one through five, in
7 addition to the requirements of subsections B and C of this section,
8 at least thirty (30) minutes of daily recess. The daily recess
9 required by this subsection may be broken up into segments to
10 accommodate each school district's instructional day. For the
11 purposes of this section, "daily recess" means a scheduled break or
12 breaks during the school day that allow students to engage in
13 unstructured free play or physical activity. Daily recess shall
14 occur outdoors when weather and other relevant conditions permit.
15 No student shall be prohibited from participating in recess as a
16 form of discipline.

17 E. The Board shall disseminate information to each school
18 district on the benefits of physical education programs and shall
19 strongly encourage districts to provide physical education
20 instruction and daily recess to students in grades six through
21 twelve. The Board shall also strongly encourage school districts to
22 incorporate physical activity into the school day by providing ~~to~~
23 ~~students in full-day kindergarten and grades one through five at~~
24 ~~least a twenty-minute daily recess, which shall be in addition to~~

1 ~~the sixty (60) minutes of physical education as required by~~
2 ~~subsection B of this section, and by allowing~~ all students brief
3 physical activity breaks throughout the day, physical activity
4 clubs, and special events.

5 ~~E.~~ F. Instruction in physical education required ~~in~~ by this
6 section shall be aligned with the subject matter standards as
7 adopted by the Board.

8 ~~F.~~ G. The physical education curriculum shall be sequential,
9 developmentally appropriate, and designed, implemented, and
10 evaluated to enable students to develop the motor and self-
11 management skills and knowledge necessary to participate in physical
12 activity throughout life. Each school district shall establish
13 specific objectives and goals the district intends to accomplish
14 through the physical education curriculum.

15 ~~G.~~ H. In identifying the essential knowledge and skills, the
16 State Board of Education shall ensure that the subject matter
17 standards for physical education:

18 1. Emphasize the knowledge and skills capable of being used
19 during a lifetime of regular physical activity;

20 2. Are consistent with national physical education standards
21 for:

22 a. the information that students should learn about
23 physical activity, and
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b. the physical activities that students should be able to perform;

3. Require that, on a weekly basis, at least fifty percent (50%) of the physical education class be used for actual student physical activity and that the activity be, to the extent practicable, at a moderate or vigorous level;

4. Offer students an opportunity to choose among many types of physical activity in which to participate;

5. Offer students both cooperative and competitive games;

6. Meet the needs of students of all physical ability levels, including students who have a disability, chronic health problem, or other special need that precludes the student from participating in regular physical education instruction but who might be able to participate in physical education that is suitably adapted and, if applicable, included in the student's individualized education program developed pursuant to the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA) or Section 504 Plan developed pursuant to the Rehabilitation Act of 1973;

7. Teach self-management and movement skills;

8. Teach cooperation, fair play, and responsible participation in physical activity;

9. Promote student participation in physical activity outside of school; and

1 10. Allow physical education classes to be an enjoyable
2 experience for students.

3 ~~H.~~ I. The Board shall ~~adopt~~ promulgate rules to implement the
4 provisions of this section.

5 SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

6 SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
7 of the public peace, health, or safety, an emergency is hereby
8 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
9 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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